ANDREW STRACHAN

M.S. Cybersecurity Candidate | SFS CyberAICorps Scholarship Recipient | UAB

Birmingham, AL | astrachan162@gmail.com | github.com/astrachan163 | **nonartificialsi.com**

SUMMARY

Cybersecurity graduate student and software builder with experience in secure web services, on-device AI, compliance operations and technical teaching. Builds practical tools, tests releases and translates technical work for students and colleagues.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Python Coding Summer Camp Teaching Assistant

University of Alabama at Birmingham (UAB), Birmingham, AL | 06/2026 - 07/2026

• Taught middle-school Python through micro:bit and drone projects; supported summer orientation.

Founder & Technologist

MaQkrs Consulting, Birmingham, AL; clients in AL, MS, TN and GA | 01/2022 - Present

• Built a secure TypeScript/Express backend for an Atlanta client, with access controls, automated security tests and an incident-response drill.

• Built client sites for Legacy Meadows and Victorious Herbal Elements; worked with **student testers** on MaQkrs AI Tutor beta builds.

Career and Technical Education (CTE) Teacher

Shades Valley High School, Birmingham, AL | 07/2024 - 06/2025

• Won the 2025 Jefferson County Board of Education Technology Torchbearer Award for Excellence for website building, 3D printing and student-built fundraiser apps.

• Advised Future Business Leaders of America (FBLA); coached esports and helped start the media team, coordinating photoshoots, video setup and student projects.

• Taught finance, customer service and sales in the National Academy of Finance to state standards.

• Organized 3D-printed ornament sales (11-12/2024), Lip Sync Battle 2025 and talent shows. Separately helped set up GoFan ticketing for a school event (03/2025).

CTE Teacher; Founding DECA Adviser

Corner High School, Dora, AL | 08/2023 - 06/2024

• Founded DECA; students placed first and second at the 2024 Alabama conference. Taught Sports & Entertainment Marketing through student-led sports posts and flyers.

• Organized Nothing Bundt Cakes and Krispy Kreme fundraising sales for Corner DECA (2024).

Operations Director

MidSouth Extracts LLC, Tupelo, MS | 01/2023 - 05/2023

• Ran a Mississippi State Department of Health (MSDH)-licensed medical cannabis processing facility; secured processor and manufactured-food approvals.

• Wrote 11 standard operating procedures (SOPs) and a Hazard Analysis and Critical Control Points (HACCP) plan; MSDH gave "A+" feedback.

• Secured Food and Drug Administration food-facility registration and City of Tupelo permits; implemented METRC tracking and weekly compliance reports.

• Prepared cost analyses and HighWay Transport's transportation-license application, approved 08/2023.

Consultant

Lampton & Worm, Mississippi | 11/2022 - 12/2022

• Drafted MidSouth license-application chapters and procedures, leading to the Operations Director role.

Sales Development Specialist; Team Lead

SelectQuote Insurance Services, Clinton, MS | 10/2021 - 11/2022

• Built new-representative training as Sales Development Specialist (04/2022 - 11/2022), addressing knowledge gaps and reducing complaints.

• Team Lead (10/2021 - 03/2022); Team Lead and Top Sales Awards (2021). Promoted from Insurance Sales Representative (04/2021 - 09/2021; 40 hours/week).

Substitute Teacher

Kelly Education, Mississippi | 08/2020 - 04/2021

• Covered classroom assignments booked through the Aesop substitute system.

BARS Compliance Checker
Kelly Services, Gulfport, MS | 08/2018 - 12/2019
• Completed compliance-check rounds in Gulfport, Hattiesburg and Picayune.

Human Anatomy Prosector
University of Mississippi School of Medicine, Jackson, MS | 05/2017 - 09/2017
• Prepared prosected dissections and demonstrated procedures to medical students.

Human Gross Anatomy Teaching Assistant
Mississippi College, Clinton, MS | 08/2015 - 05/2016
• Guided cadaver labs, enforced safety protocols and graded lab work.

CERTIFICATIONS & COMPETITIONS

• **DragonByte Cyber Club, UAB** (01/2026 - Present): wrote 25% of challenges for the first UAB capture-the-flag (CTF) contest for Alabama middle-school students (04/2026).
• **Alabama High School Programming Contest, UAB** (09/2026): coordinated teams, student activities and teacher communication; Certificate of Appreciation.
• **Microsoft Certified Educator**, 05/2025; 14 Google Cloud skill badges, 2024-2025; Alabama emergency teaching certificate (2023).

LEADERSHIP & VOLUNTEER SERVICE

• **Chair, Opioid Crisis Council** (2018), University of Mississippi Medical Center (UMMC) and Mississippi Bureau of Narcotics: convened about 27 university and state leaders.
• **President & Founder, Peer-Assisted Learning Society**, UMMC (2017); **Virginia Covington Award (2018)**, recognizing a role-model medical student.
• **Event Coordinator (Volunteer), UAB Computer Science International Food Festival** (04/2026): one of three coordinators for about 45 attendees.
• **Assistant Youth Leader (Volunteer)**, Gulfport, MS (08/2011 - Present; about 1-2 hours/week, seasonal): led overnight trips for 30+ youth.
• **President, Quality Improvement Student Interest Group**, and **Associated Student Body Quality Improvement Chair for Education**, UMMC, 2017-2018.
• **Certified Village Health Team member, OmniMed**, Uganda (07-08/2017): helped establish mobile clinics, taught hygiene and helped build latrines and mud stoves.
• **Benjamin A. Gilman Scholar**, Nepal (06-08/2014): hospital intern through World Endeavors and Reach the World classroom travel correspondent.
• **Volunteer Youth Mentor**, Harrison County Children's Shelter, Gulfport, MS (05/2011 - 01/2018): mentored youth on long-term goals and life skills.

TECHNICAL PROJECTS

• **Personal Agentic Citadel:** Java gateway for artificial intelligence (AI) agents: rate limits, schema-locked tools, allowlisted file writes and no browser key. Private repository; demo on request.
• **MaQkrs AI Tutor (pre-release beta):** built an on-device SwiftUI study app using Apple models and Gemma via MLX Swift; SHA-256-verified model downloads. Presented at UAB, 04/2026.
• **Blockchain (CS 646):** led quality assurance for a five-person Python team; signed transactions, Transmission Control Protocol gossip, continuous integration and release packaging.
• **Secure cloud file sharing (CS 633):** private Amazon Web Services storage, per-recipient signed links and deletion after all recipients download; demo video.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

• **Security:** Wireshark, Nmap, threat modeling, zero-trust access control, vulnerability scanning; computer forensics coursework.
• **Software and cloud:** Python, C, Java, Swift/SwiftUI, TypeScript, SQL, GitHub Actions, Terraform; Amazon Web Services, Google Cloud, Firebase; Linux.

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

• **ESL professional development**, Jefferson County Board of Education, 2024-2025; **Google Cloud Trusted Tester (Veo 2)**, 2025.
• DECA International Career Development Conference, 04/2024; Alabama Career and Technical Education summer conference, 07/2024; Jump$tart National Educator Conference, 11/2024.

EDUCATION

University of Alabama at Birmingham (UAB)
Birmingham, AL | 01/2026 - Expected 12/2027
• Master of Science, Cybersecurity; Cyber Crime Investigation concentration; full-time; GPA 3.75.
• **NSA Center of Academic Excellence in Cyber Research (CAE-R).**
• Completed: Object-Oriented Programming, Systems Programming, Networking; Network Security, Cloud Computing.
• Current (Fall 2026): Computer Forensics, Computer Security, Blockchain and Cryptocurrency.

University of Montevallo
Montevallo, AL | 08/2024 - 05/2025
• Non-degree coursework toward an Alabama teaching certificate; GPA 3.66.
• Field: Business, Marketing, and Finance.

University of Mississippi School of Medicine
Jackson, MS | 2016 - 2020
• Medical Studies, Course and clinical work.

Mississippi College
Clinton, MS | 08/2011 - 05/2016
• B.S. double major: American Chemical Society-certified Biochemistry and Biological Medical Sciences.
• Music minor; cum laude; GPA 3.50.
• Alpha Epsilon Delta, member 2014-2015; Delta Epsilon Iota; Phi Mu Alpha; Senior Class Senator.